

In This Moment

Dr David Paul, 1955 to 2023, went from Royal Marines officer to engineer to one of the most quietly copied trading teachers alive. **His whole philosophy fits in four words: discipline, simplicity, expectancy, presence.**

01 The moment

A goalkeeper cannot know where the ball is going. **He can only be set, balanced and awake when it is struck.** Over one shot that looks like luck. Over a hundred shots it is the whole job. Paul taught trading the same way.

- **Presence over prediction.** Being fully in the current bar beats having a view about the next hour. A view is a story. Attention is a skill.
- **Simplicity over complexity.** More indicators feel like more control. They mostly add places to hide from a decision you already know how to make.
- **Discipline over impulse.** The rule you wrote when calm outranks the certainty you feel when hot, every single time.
- **One thing, done the same way.** Paul traded a small number of setups for decades rather than collecting new ones.

02 Expectancy

The goalkeeper does not ask whether he will save the next shot. **He asks what his save rate is across a season.**

- **Expectancy is the only honest scoreboard.** Win rate times average win, minus loss rate times average loss. A trader can be right most of the time and still go broke.
- **A loss inside the plan is not a mistake.** It is a cost of doing business and it was priced in before entry.
- **A win outside the plan is not a success.** It is a bill that has not arrived yet.
- **The edge shows up in the aggregate or not at all.** Any single trade is close to noise, which is why judging yourself by it is the fastest way to abandon a working method.

THE ONE IDEA

Prediction asks what will happen next. Expectancy asks what happens on average across a hundred repetitions. Only one of those two questions has an answer, and it is not the interesting one.

SOURCES & NOTE

Sources: Dr Ulrik Vangstrup, In. This. Moment., a biography of Dr David Paul; Published David Paul lectures and interviews, 2010 to 2022; Tom Hougaard on Paul as his mentor.

Dr David Paul lived 1955 to 2023 and did not publish a trading book of his own. This guide is built from a biography written about him and from his recorded talks. Educational, not financial advice.